

Earth timelapse

Check out this amazing six-month time lapse video of Earth from space taken from aboard the International Space Station <http://dgit.in/EarthLapse>



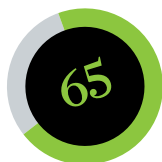
Ancient colour vision

Eyes from 300 million old fossils show rod and cone cells indicating coloured vision <http://dgit.in/AncientCol>

Bazaar

Astrum BT-021N Luxury Bass

Feature rich average performer



Performance.....50
Features77
Design & Build60
Value for Money75

Specifications

Interface: Bluetooth 3.0 with NFC, AUX, USB;
Rated battery life: Up to 7-10hours; **Power:** 5W RMS; **Mic:** Omni directional/noise filter Microphone; **Battery specs:** 1600mAh, 5-7Hrs Charging time

Contact

Astrum Holdings
Email: info@astrumttd.com
Website: <http://www.astrumttd.com/>

This little Bluetooth speaker bears a striking resemblance to the much more expensive and premium Cambridge Audio Minx Air 200 wireless speaker we'd received a while ago. Of course, the Astrum BT-021N is about 5 times more compact and 10 times cheaper. In fact, it's one of the least expensive Bluetooth speakers we've received. Putting it head on with our best value winner from last year, the Zook BS100, we noticed a lot of differences. First, the Astrum speaker has managed to throw in NFC at this throwaway price which is quite commendable. Second, it's got a 5V USB out, which is quite rare not just at this price point but even otherwise. Very few speakers like the JBL Charge give you the option to charge your devices using this battery that you're anyway lugging around.



Price
₹2,699

Now for the flip side: the speaker isn't the best performer out there. While there is some bass, it's accompanied by distortion as well. The speaker produced about the same volume output as the Zook BS100 perhaps a smidgen less but not too much. At this price point you can't

expect stellar audio quality and that is what you get – something that greatly amplifies the capabilities of your smartphone speakers but not much else. If you're looking for clarity, precision, and all those lofty "luxurious" ideals you'll need to look elsewhere and be prepared to shell out more moolah. But if you're looking for a feature rich device that amplifies your music, can double up as a power-bank for those tight situations, then look no further, the Astrum BT-021 is your speaker.

Siddharth Parwatay

SimpleAudio Go

Simple yet superior

Early last year, PC components manufacturer Corsair announced the acquisition of Simple Audio, a company specialised in developing home audio streaming solutions. The Go portable Bluetooth speaker is the result of this partnership and is supposed to bring with it the acquired know-how from the Scottish audio makers. The speaker is slightly curved along its front grille, with the edges sweeping back. Both in terms of size and design, the speaker can't help but remind you of the Ultimate Ears Mobile Boombox portable speaker, which for some time now has been our "go-to" recommendation for anyone looking for a compact Bluetooth speaker that does not compromise on audio quality. With the SimpleAudio Go, that recommendation might just change.

In a head-to-head comparison the Go was able to deliver deeper bass on many of

our test tracks. One of the things we'd liked about the UE M Boombox was that no matter how much you push it (nearly 100 percent volume), the speaker just wouldn't distort. It's similar with the Go but it's much louder! Acoustic tracks open up and unlike the Boombox which was warm, the Go speaker clearly is tuned to have a bright sound signature. That's not to say the mid range or lows aren't well repre-

sented, they are, but only as much as you can expect from a speaker this size.

When the UE Mobile Boombox launched it was priced at an atrocious ₹8,995 but soon it dropped to around 5k. The Go is priced at ₹6,999 to begin with so hopefully you'll be able to pick it up for lesser already. At the MRP though, it's recommended for someone who just does not want to carry something bulkier like the JBL Flip variants.

Siddharth Parwatay



Price
₹6,999



Features63
Performance.....77
Build72
Value65

Specifications

Dimensions: 12.5 cm x 6.5 cm x 6 cm; **Bluetooth:** 3.0 A2DP; **Inputs:** Aux 3.5 mm; **Other features:** Microphone; **In the box:** 3.5mm cable and carrying pouch

Contact

Corsair India
Telephone: 9845651608
Email: indiaservice@corsair.com
Website: www.corsair.com